Meet the relatives

Reptiles have a long history – their relatives date back to the days of the dinosaurs. Crocodiles are the closest-living relatives of the dinosaurs, but they were not the first reptiles to inhabit our world.



The fossilized remains of a prehistoric turtle.

Turtle power

Turtles have lived on Earth longer than any other group of reptiles. Their distant relatives may have been around at the same time as the very first dinosaurs.

Tuatara time

Although there are not many of them around today, tuataras certainly stick around for a long time. They reach adulthood at the age of 20, but are still growing at 60, and can live to be 120 years old.

Last of the Beak-heads

The reptiles of the *Rhynchocephalia* group, or "Beak-head" reptiles, were plentiful during the age of the dinosaurs – but today, the tuatara is the only species left in the group. Tuataras are relatives of the *Homeosaurus* – a similar-looking creature from the same group – that lived about 140 million years ago.

